



BEYOND THE TEXTBOOK

Build Your First Website with Smart Tools & AI

Beginner | IT / Computer Science Track | Live Workshop

How to learn web development, what matters right now, and the free AI tools and cloud services that turn a school project into a live website.

HTML · CSS · JS

Google Sites & Wix

AI Tools

Formspree

Supabase

GitHub Pages

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WHY BUILD FOR THE INTERNET

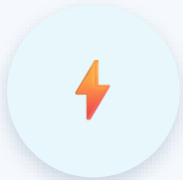
Your Digital Identity

A marksheet shows your score. A website shows what you can actually do.



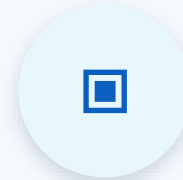
Stand Out

College and internship applications stand out with a link to your own work.



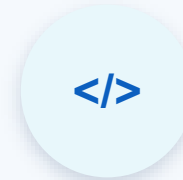
Real Skills

Show working projects, not just a line saying “I know HTML”.



Interactive Resume

Let people click, scroll, and try what you have built.



The Web's Language

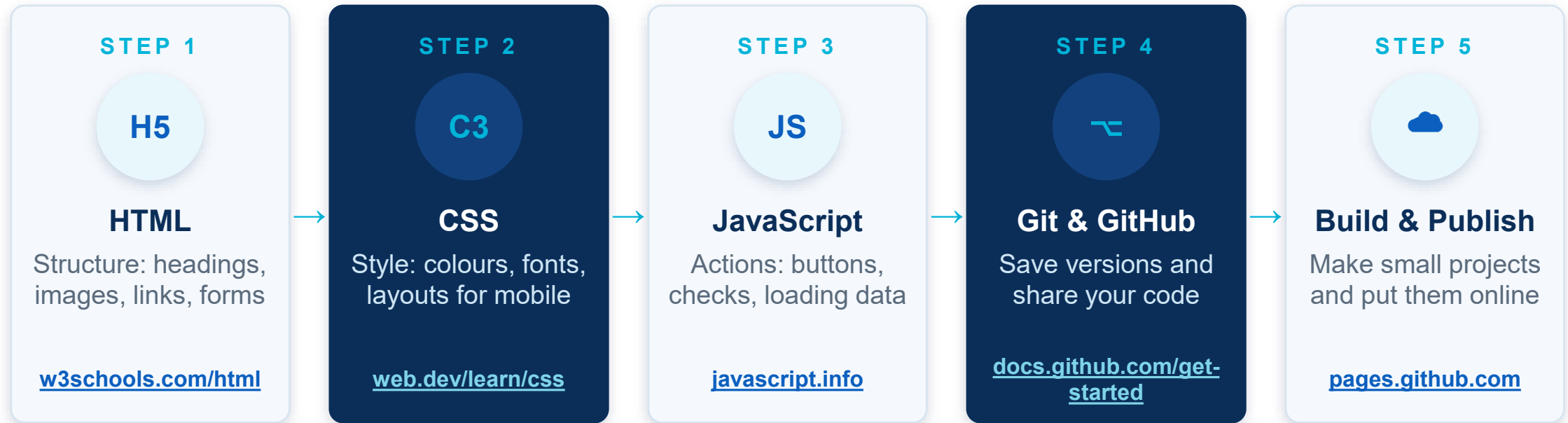
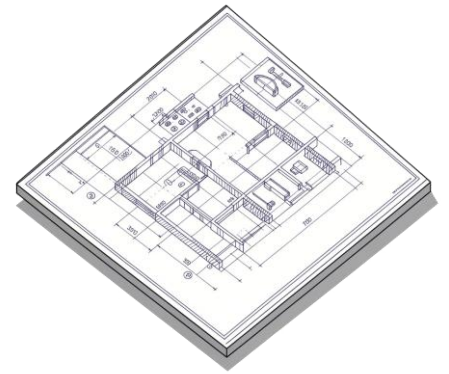
Learn the same code that powers every site you use daily.

Example: `yourname.github.io` → a free personal website link you can put on your CV, LinkedIn, or school / college application.

HOW TO EARN WEB SKILLS

Your Web Skills Roadmap

Five steps, in this order. Each one has a free place to learn it.



Free full courses:

freecodecamp.org

developer.mozilla.org

theodinproject.com

codepen.io

Tip: 30 minutes a day + one small project every week beats cramming before exams / interviews.

WHAT MATTERS RIGHT NOW

What You Need to Know Today

AI writes a lot of code now - so these basics matter more, not less.



HTML & CSS basics

Every page, even one written by AI, is still HTML and CSS underneath.



A little JavaScript

Enough to handle a button click, check a form, or load data.



Git & GitHub

Your cloud backup, your portfolio, and how teams share code.



Mobile-first design

Most visitors use phones. Test every page on a small screen.



Prompting + checking AI

Ask AI clearly, then read, run, and test what it gives you.



Online safety basics

Never put passwords or secret keys inside your page code.

NO-CODE OPTION

Drag & Drop: Google Sites and Wix

Google Sites



A live website in under an hour, with no code. Quick to start, but limited.



Google Sites

sites.google.com



sites.google.com/view/yourname

GOOD FOR

- ✓ Free with any Google account
- ✓ Class project, club, or event page
- ✓ Embed Google Forms, Docs, YouTube

LIMITS

- ✗ Few layout and design choices
- ✗ No custom HTML/CSS for the whole page
- ✗ Basic SEO controls



Wix

wix.com



yourname.wixsite.com/portfolio

GOOD FOR

- ✓ Hundreds of ready-made templates
- ✓ Drag anything anywhere on the page
- ✓ Built-in forms, galleries, blog

LIMITS

- ✗ Free plan shows Wix ads and branding
- ✗ Own domain name needs a paid plan
- ✗ Hard to move your site elsewhere

Best use: a quick event, club, or class page today. For your portfolio and anything with a database, learn to code it.

Quick Builder or Your Own Code?

Use builders to launch fast. Learn code to go further.



DRAG & DROP

Fast, but restricted

- ✗ Locked into one platform
- ✗ Heavy, generic page code
- ✗ Limited control over SEO
- ✗ Only the features they offer

YOUR OWN CODE

Flexible and fully yours

- ✓ You own every line; host it anywhere
- ✓ Clean HTML that loads faster
- ✓ Proper tags that help Google find you
- ✓ Add any feature: forms, database, login



Smart path: start a Google Site this week, and build the same page in HTML and CSS next month. Then compare them.

AI TOOLS THAT SAVE TIME

Your AI Helpers

Four tools, four jobs. Use them to learn faster, not to skip learning.

 Claude

 Gemini

 Google Antigravity

 GitHub Copilot



Claude

claude.ai

Explains code step by step and builds complete pages you can preview.

“Make a one-page portfolio with a contact section.”

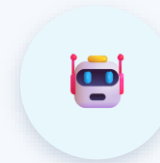


Gemini

gemini.google.com

Research, ideas, and fixing errors. Works with Google Docs and Drive.

“Why does my layout break on mobile?”



GitHub Copilot

github.com/features/copilot

Suggests code as you type inside VS Code. Has a free plan; free Student plan after verification.

Type a comment, press Tab to accept.



Google Antigravity

antigravity.google

AI-first code editor. Agents plan, write, and test a project for you. Free tier.

“Build a quiz app and test it.”

Check age rules before signing up: Claude requires users to be 18+. Gemini's free student plan is for university students aged 18+. Copilot Student needs education.github.com verification. Under 18? Explore with a teacher or parent.

Use AI Like an Architect, Not a Typist

A good prompt gives a good start. Your knowledge makes it correct.



AI chat - sample prompt

YOU

"Create a simple portfolio page in HTML and CSS with my name, three projects, and a contact form. Keep it mobile-friendly and explain each part."

AI

Here's your page: <header>, <section id="projects">, and a <form>... Your .projects grid uses display: grid; on phones it becomes one column.

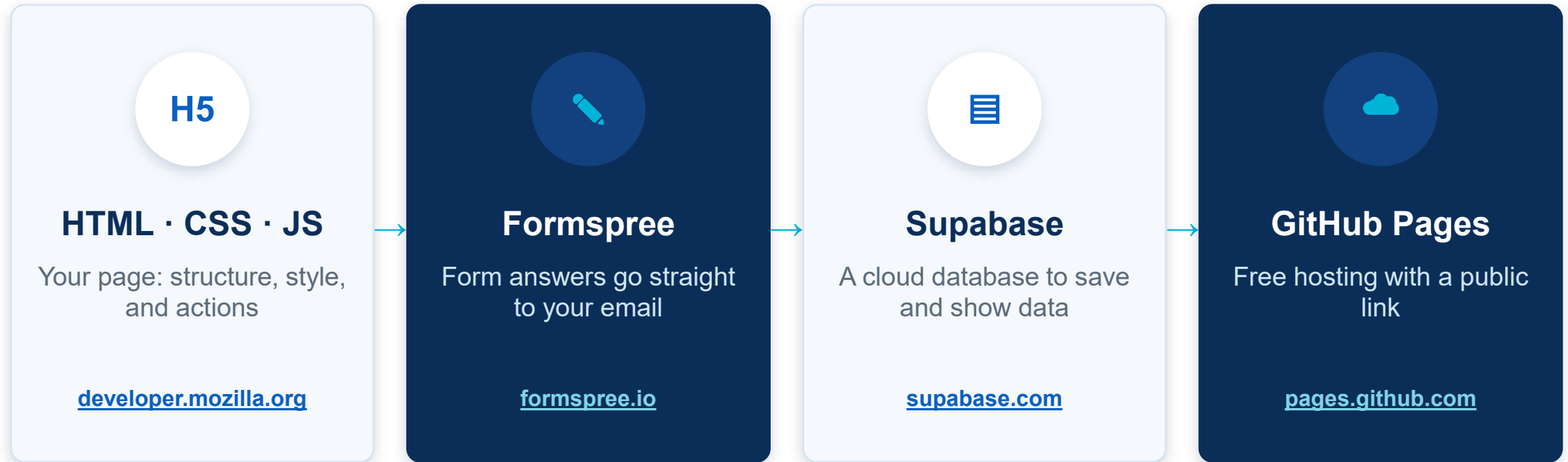
THE ARCHITECT'S CHECKLIST

- ✓ Say exactly what you want: page, sections, style
- ✓ Read every line; ask "explain this line"
- ✓ Run it and test on your phone
- ✓ Fix one error at a time with AI's help
- ✓ Never paste passwords or secret keys
- ✓ Mention AI help in your project report

SIMPLE TOOLS, GLOBAL REACH

The Modern Tech Stack

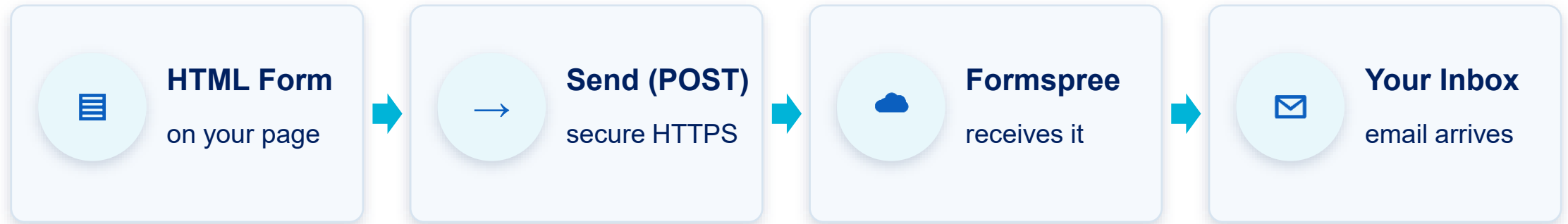
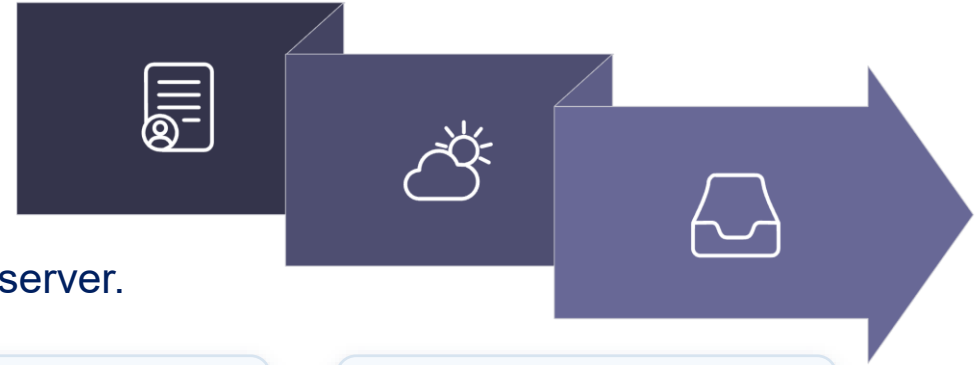
Four free pieces take you from a file on your laptop to a live website with real data.



AI tools help at every step: writing the page, connecting the form, and fixing errors.

A Contact Form in 5 Minutes

Visitor fills the form, and the message arrives in your email. No PHP, no server.



```
contact.html – the only line to change is action="..."  
<form action="https://formspree.io/f/YOUR_ID"  
  method="POST">  
  <input type="email" name="email" required>  
  <textarea name="message"></textarea>  
  <button type="submit">Send</button>  
</form>
```

HOW TO SET IT UP

- 1 Sign up at formspree.io
 - 2 Create a form, copy its ID
 - 3 Paste it into action="..."
 - 4 Upload the page and test it
- Free plan: 50 submissions/month**

Save Data and Show It on Your Page

Think of it as a Google Sheet your website can read and write, but it's a real PostgreSQL database.



supabase.com/dashboard > Table Editor > feedback

id	name	message	created_at
1	Asha	Loved the quiz page!	29-09 10:15
2	Rohan	Add a dark mode please	29-09 10:22
3	Meera	Form works on my phone	29-09 10:31

Example: a class guestbook. Visitors post feedback, and the page lists every message.



Database

Tables with rows and columns



Login (Auth)

Email or Google sign-in



Storage

Upload images and files

Free plan: 2 projects · 500 MB database · 1 GB file storage. Projects pause after 1 week without use. supabase.com

Guestbook in a Few Lines of JavaScript

Save a message, then read all messages back. That's a full-stack app.



```
<script src="https://cdn.jsdelivr.net/npm/
    @supabase/supabase-js@2"></script>
<script type="module">
const db = supabase.createClient(
  "https://YOUR-PROJECT.supabase.co",
  "YOUR_PUBLISHABLE_KEY");

// 1. Save a message
await db.from("feedback")
  .insert({ name: "Asha", message: "Great site!" });
// 2. Read all messages
const { data } = await db.from("feedback").select("*");
</script>
```

1 **Create a project**
supabase.com/dashboard

2 **Make a table “feedback”**
Table Editor → New table

3 **Turn on Row Level Security**
Add a policy for insert + select

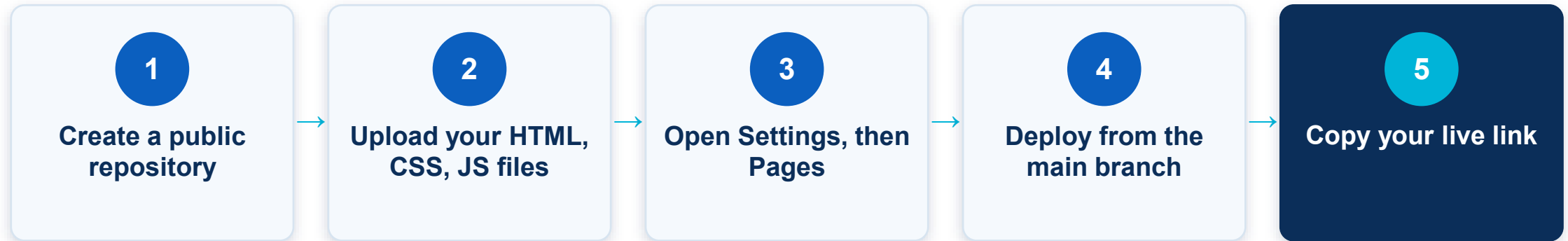
4 **Copy URL + publishable key**
Project Settings → API Keys

Formspree = “email me the message” **Supabase** = “store it and show it on my site” **Never use the secret key in a web page**

DEPLOYMENT

Going Global with GitHub Pages

Five steps from files on your laptop to a public link.



github.com/username/repo/settings/pages

✓ **Your site is live at**
`yourname.github.io/repo`

A site on your laptop is invisible. This is the moment it goes public for anyone, anywhere.

Guide: pages.github.com · Sign up: github.com/signup

KEEP BUILDING

Your Next Steps

Everything from today, plus sample code, in one starter repository.



Starter Repo

[github.com/prakash-ukhalkar/
beyond-the-textbook-starter](https://github.com/prakash-ukhalkar/beyond-the-textbook-starter)

- ✓ This presentation
- ✓ Guidelines for using AI tools
- ✓ Contact form sample with Formsfree
- ✓ Guestbook sample with Supabase
- ✓ Step-by-step setup instructions

Practice



codepen.io

Try code in the browser

Learn



freecodecamp.org

Free certified courses

Reference



developer.mozilla.org

The web's dictionary

Check your site



pagespeed.web.dev

Speed, SEO, and
accessibility

THIS WEEK'S CHALLENGE

Build a one-page portfolio, add a Formsfree contact form, and publish it on GitHub Pages. Share your link with the classmate / course teacher.

Thank You

Time to build your first website.



prakashu.edu@gmail.com

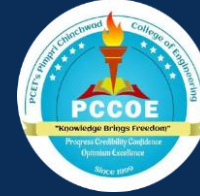


github.com/prakash-ukhalkar



linkedin.com/in/prakash-ukhalkar

Learn the basics. Use AI wisely. Publish something every week.



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Assistant Professor (MCA), PCCoE, Pune

